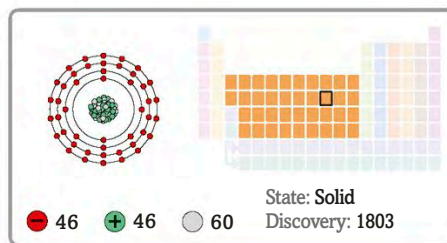


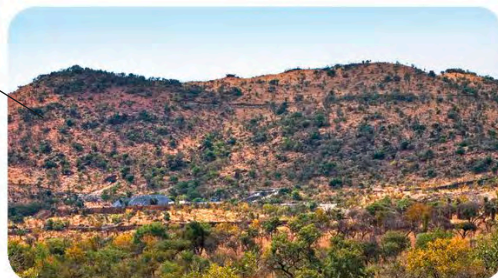
46
Pd

Palladium



Forms

The mines in this area have a high concentration of palladium.



Blue Ridge mines, South Africa

Palladium absorbs **hydrogen**, like a sponge soaking up water.

Pure form can be produced by separating it from the ores of other metals, such as copper and nickel.

Pure palladium pellet refined in a laboratory



Uses

The converter gets hotter as more pollutants enter the exhaust.



This device uses palladium compounds that change colour when poisonous carbon monoxide is detected, which triggers an alarm.



Carbon monoxide detector

This commemorative coin is made from the palladium produced by the Stillwater Mining company in Montana, USA.



Palladium is a rare, precious metal: it is 10 times rarer than silver and twice as rare as gold. Like these metals, palladium has a shiny surface and does not corrode easily. Palladium is found **pure** in nature, but it also has a few rare minerals, such as braggite. Of its

many applications, the element's main use is in **catalytic converters**, which are devices used in vehicles to convert poisonous exhaust gases into less harmful ones. A compound called palladium chloride is used in **carbon monoxide detectors**. Because the element is